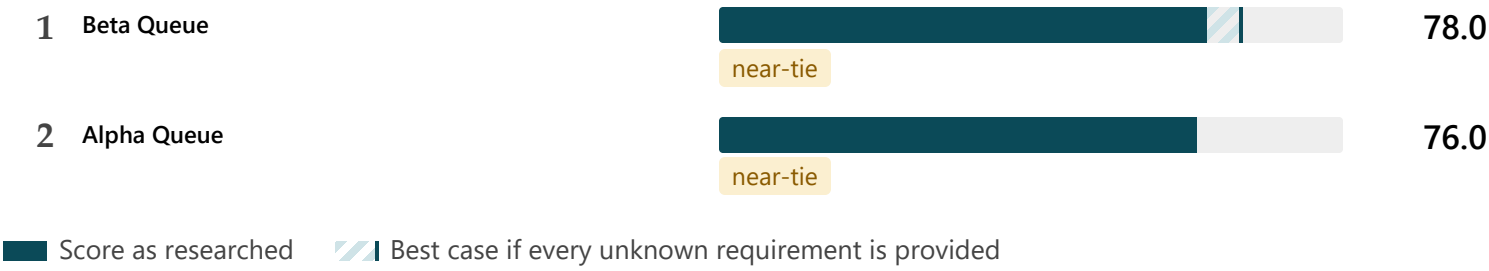
Background task queue

Evaluation date **2026-10-01** Report date **2026-10-02** Scale **0 to 5** Cost mode **weighted**

Beta Queue scores 78.0 of 100, 2.0 ahead of Alpha Queue.

The ranking is not settled: the lead is inside the near-tie margin.



Recommendation and notes

Recommendation: the choice between Beta Queue and Alpha Queue is not clear-cut (78.0 against 76.0, inside the 3-point tie margin). Beta Queue leads on core capabilities, but its operability claims are unverified, and lowering those low-confidence scores puts Alpha Queue ahead. Verify the metrics support of Beta Queue before committing.

See `scores.json` and `features.md` for the full numbers. Gamma Queue was excluded because it fails the delivery gate (E-010).

Decision table

2 options ranked

Rank	1
Option	Beta Queue (near-tie)
Weighted score (of 100)	78.0
Low-confidence criteria	1
Must-have gaps	1
Unknown requirements	0
Best case if unknowns are provided	84.0

Rank	2
Option	Alpha Queue (near-tie)
Weighted score (of 100)	76.0
Low-confidence criteria	0
Must-have gaps	1
Unknown requirements	0
Best case if unknowns are provided	76.0

Near-tie between Beta Queue, Alpha Queue; broken by higher score on highest-weight criterion.

Criteria and weights

3 criteria

Criterion	Core capabilities
Weight	50
Requirements	F-01, F-02

Criterion	Operability
Weight	30
Requirements	N-01, N-02

Criterion	Cost
Weight	20
Requirements	C-01, C-02

Bias and assumption checks

- No requirement is marked as an assumption.
- Findings by source: Alpha Queue: 1 vendor, 4 independent or open source; Beta Queue: 1 vendor, 3 independent or open source.
- Cost compares 2 of 2 options; the others have no published price.

Weighted score matrix

3 criteria, 2 options

Criterion	Core capabilities
Weight	50
Beta Queue	5
high	
Alpha Queue	4
high	

Criterion	Operability
Weight	30
Beta Queue	2†
low	
Alpha Queue	4
medium	

Criterion	Cost
Weight	20
Beta Queue	4
medium	
Alpha Queue	3
medium	

Criterion	**Weighted total**
Weight	**100**
Beta Queue	**78.0**
Alpha Queue	**76.0**

† score capped because the evidence is unverified. Confidence: high = two sources, medium = one, low = none. Independent sources count, and the vendor's official documentation counts once for what a product provides.

Feature-by-feature comparison

6 requirements in 3 groups

Core

provided: Beta Queue 2/2, Alpha Queue 1/2

ID	F-01
Requirement	At-least-once delivery of jobs
Priority	must
Beta Queue	provided E-006
Alpha Queue	provided E-001

ID	F-02
Requirement	Delayed and scheduled jobs
Priority	should
Beta Queue	provided E-007
Alpha Queue	partial no recurring schedules E-002

Operations

provided: Beta Queue 1/2, Alpha Queue 1/2

ID	N-01
Requirement	Metrics and health endpoints for monitoring
Priority	must
Beta Queue	partial via plugin, vendor claim only E-008
Alpha Queue	provided E-003

ID	N-02
Requirement	Web dashboard for inspecting jobs
Priority	could
Beta Queue	provided E-008
Alpha Queue	not provided no dashboard found

Cost

provided: Beta Queue 1/2, Alpha Queue 1/2

ID	C-01
Requirement	Predictable pricing at 5 million jobs per month
Priority	must
Beta Queue	provided self-hosted E-009
Alpha Queue	partial tiered, volume discount E-004

ID	C-02
Requirement	A usable free tier for development
Priority	should
Beta Queue	partial no hosted free tier
Alpha Queue	provided 100k jobs free E-005

Cost: total cost of ownership

USD over 36 months

Over 36 months, in USD. Prices come from the sources listed below; components marked unverified rest on weak evidence, and components marked assumed are placeholders, not published prices.

Assumption	Jobs per month
Value	5,000,000
Unit	jobs/month
Scales in scenarios	yes

Assumption	Developers
Value	4
Unit	people
Scales in scenarios	no

Option	Beta Queue
Monthly	380.00
One-time	2,000.00
Total over horizon	15,680.00
Vs cheapest	1.00x
Notes	unverified: b-plugin

Option	Alpha Queue
Monthly	1,260.00
One-time	0.00
Total over horizon	45,360.00
Vs cheapest	2.89x

Volume scenarios

Scenario	pilot (100k jobs/month)
Beta Queue	15,680.00
Alpha Queue	3,600.00
Cheapest	Alpha Queue

Scenario	growth (10M jobs/month)
Beta Queue	15,680.00
Alpha Queue	81,360.00
Cheapest	Beta Queue

Components

Option	Beta Queue
Component	Hosting (2 nodes)
Monthly	300.00
One-time	0.00

Option	Beta Queue
Component	Monitoring plugin
Monthly	80.00
One-time	0.00
Evidence	unverified

Option	Beta Queue
Component	Initial setup
Monthly	0.00
One-time	2,000.00

Option	Alpha Queue
Component	Job volume
Monthly	1,160.00
One-time	0.00

Option	Alpha Queue
Component	Support plan
Monthly	100.00
One-time	0.00

Sensitivity

top option holds in all 6 tests

Each of the highest-weight criteria moved by 5 points, other weights rescaled.

Criterion	Core capabilities
Change	+5
Top option	Beta Queue
Top changed	no
Beta Queue	80.2
Alpha Queue	76.4

Criterion	Core capabilities
Change	-5
Top option	Beta Queue
Top changed	no
Beta Queue	75.8
Alpha Queue	75.6

Criterion	Operability
Change	+5
Top option	Beta Queue
Top changed	no
Beta Queue	75.3
Alpha Queue	76.3

Criterion	Operability
Change	-5
Top option	Beta Queue
Top changed	no
Beta Queue	80.7
Alpha Queue	75.7

Criterion	Cost
Change	+5
Top option	Beta Queue
Top changed	no
Beta Queue	78.1
Alpha Queue	75.0

Criterion	Cost
Change	-5
Top option	Beta Queue
Top changed	no
Beta Queue	77.9
Alpha Queue	77.0

Confidence tests

Test	all low-confidence scores lowered by one
Top option	Alpha Queue
Top changed	yes

Test	Beta Queue / Operability lowered by one
Top option	Alpha Queue
Top changed	yes

Excluded options

1 options

Option	Gamma Queue
Reason	Fails F-01: no at-least-once delivery (E-010)

Sources

10 findings

ID	E-001
Option	Alpha Queue
Requirement	F-01
Finding	Delivers at least once under failure injection
Source	bench.example.org
Source date	2026-08-01
Confidence	CONFIRMED
Kind	independent

ID	E-002
Option	Alpha Queue
Requirement	F-02
Finding	Delayed jobs supported, recurring schedules are not
Source	review.example.net
Source date	2026-07-15
Confidence	PROBABLE
Kind	independent

ID	E-003
Option	Alpha Queue
Requirement	N-01
Finding	Exposes Prometheus metrics and a health endpoint
Source	review.example.net
Source date	2026-07-15
Confidence	PROBABLE
Kind	independent

ID	E-004
Option	Alpha Queue
Requirement	C-01
Finding	Tiered pricing with a volume discount above 1M jobs
Source	alpha.example.com
Source date	2026-09-01
Confidence	PRIMARY
Kind	vendor

ID	E-005
Option	Alpha Queue
Requirement	C-02
Finding	Free tier of 100k jobs per month
Source	bench.example.org
Source date	2026-08-01
Confidence	PROBABLE
Kind	independent

ID	E-006
Option	Beta Queue
Requirement	F-01
Finding	At-least-once delivery confirmed in tests
Source	bench.example.org
Source date	2026-08-01
Confidence	CONFIRMED
Kind	independent

ID	E-007
Option	Beta Queue
Requirement	F-02
Finding	Delayed and recurring jobs supported
Source	docs-mirror.example.net
Source date	2026-06-20
Confidence	PROBABLE
Kind	independent

ID	E-008
Option	Beta Queue
Requirement	N-01
Finding	Vendor says metrics are available through a plugin
Source	beta.example.com
Source date	2026-09-10
Confidence	UNVERIFIED
Kind	vendor

ID	E-009
Option	Beta Queue
Requirement	C-01
Finding	Open source; hosting cost is predictable
Source	review.example.net
Source date	2026-07-15
Confidence	PROBABLE
Kind	independent

ID	E-010
Option	Gamma Queue
Requirement	F-01
Finding	At-most-once delivery only
Source	bench.example.org
Source date	2026-08-01
Confidence	CONFIRMED
Kind	independent
